Ysbyty Gwynedd
Anaesthetics Department
Adran Anaestheteg

OPERATIONAL POLICY

Post-procedural review of patients

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Key Points

- Anaesthetists have a responsibility for their patients peri-operatively
- Anaesthetists are specialists in peri-operative medicine
- Low risk patients are likely to have been discharged before anaesthetic review possible
- High risk patients are likely to be managed in critical care facilities.

Context of post-operative anaesthetic responsibility

Anaesthetists manage a variety of patients and operations. Patient safety is paramount so Anaesthetists should only transfer any clinical responsibility to another clinician who is competent. Patients should not be taken to Theatre Recovery unless they are stable and not intubated.

The Postoperative section of the anaesthetic chart should be used to document instructions for recovery and the ward as required.

The appropriate assessment of the post-operative patient will depend on each individual patient, their operation and their anaesthetic.

Specific Patient Groups

Obstetric patients are followed up on the first and second days post procedure by the on-call obstetric anaesthetist (Bleep 551) using the 'Obstetric Procedure, Complication & Follow up Book'. This is kept in the Labour Ward Epidural Trolley. It is a formalised review with standardised questions. It is audited annually.

High risk patients admitted to ITU are followed up by the Intensivists and those to HDU by the Consultant anaesthetist covering HDU that day.

Low risk patients who are day-cases will often be discharged before the anaesthetist can review them. The nursing staff have standards to apply before discharge and will contact the anaesthetist if there are any specific concerns.

Emergency patients that require follow up are detailed on handover with the 063 bleep. The details are on the Emergency Theatre List of patients and the back of the 063 Handover Form.

Day case patients are discharged from Tudno ward using their Criteria for Nurse Led Discharge Form.

The Post-operative Anaesthetic Review Diary is kept in Theatre Recovery. Anaesthetists enter patients into this diary if they require follow up the next day. The HDU Consultant of the day will review this group of patients.

There are forms kept in Theatre Recovery that The Acute Pain Team uses to review all patients who have a PCA, epidural or other complex or pain issues.

The process of Handover of Patient Care should be performed as per the Anaesthetic YG Guideline for Handover.

References

ODSOP 14 Recovering patients following anaesthesia

ODSOP 66 Patient handover criteria

YG OPG 006 Anaesthetic Guideline Handover of Patient Care